

HOW YOU TEST

We've given you a separate Digit book dedicated to stuff to DO. However, one of the most important services Digit provides to you is imparting knowledge, especially when it comes to telling you what to buy and why. We've done this over the years in the form of comparison tests, bazaar reviews, online reviews, video reviews, etc.

We're not impressed by popularity, price or perception – we never have been, and encourage you to not be either. What really matters for all products, across all categories, is actually simple – they should have all the features you need (some of which you'll need later) and not be ridiculously priced, so as to give you the best value for your hard-earned money.

How do we do this? We test. Rigorously. We dare say that we're a lot harsher on products than most others, and we're actually going to get even rougher on products going forward. You already know why this is needed: the performance difference between products is decreasing, with most of them made in China, at identically specced fabrication units and with almost identical product designs. It's a me-too world and true innovation is indeed rare.

However, with this issue, we're going one step further than vanilla buying advice and giving you our own testing secrets, to try to get you to think like an experienced Digit Test Centre reviewer. Why? Because unlike us, you don't have brands sending you their products to test. There are really three ways by which you can tell a good deal from a bad one: First, one of your friends happens to have the product you want and you're able to get your hands on it to check it out and even run benchmarks; the second way might be if you come across the product displayed in a store where you're allowed to fiddle with it to try it out, and hopefully also

run a few benchmarks there; the third, however, is the most common way you'll compare products, and that's by looking at its specs and reviews online, and trying to decide whether it's worth throwing money at.

The first question we were asked when planning this cover story was, "If I trust Digit and the way it ranks products, why should I need to know any of this." The simple answer: because your needs are becoming more unique, and although we can account for most of those needs, we can't account for all of them. Besides, this is a good chance for us to show off how much thought and planning goes into what's usually considered a "simple review".

In the pages that follow, we're going to attempt to impart enough knowledge for you to be able to do better at ranking products no matter which of the three scenarios you find yourself in. Of course, we want you to write in to us and let us know how we did, what we missed and also elaborate on any specific category. Send feedback to editor@digit.in as always...

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